FREE CHECKLIST · November 2026

Local SEO Checklist

Checks for Google Business Profile, NAP consistency, reviews, local pages and measurement to improve visibility in Maps and local search.

7 sections · 39 checks

How to use this checklist

Complete the Google Business Profile section first, then move on to the others and verify each item with the method beside it. High priority marks steps that directly affect visibility or profile safety, medium marks work that builds a competitive edge, and low marks extra improvements.

Priority: **High** **Medium** **Low**

01 Google Business Profile: core information

- ☐ **Check that the Business Profile is verified under a Google account you own and has at least two managers.** — High
  How: Search your business name on Google, open the profile management panel and review owners and managers under People and access.
- ☐ **Enter the business name exactly as it appears on signage and official documents; do not add keywords or city names.** — High
  How: Compare the profile name with your signage, invoices and website; remove any added descriptors.
- ☐ **Choose the narrowest, most accurate category for your business as the primary category.** — High
  How: Search the category list in the profile editor; also review the primary categories of top-ranking competitors.
- ☐ **Add secondary categories only for services you genuinely offer and keep them few.** — Medium
  How: Match each secondary category to a service page on your website; remove those without one.
- ☐ **If you do not serve customers at your address, hide it and define service areas; if you do, enter the full address.** — High
  How: Check the location and service area settings in the profile; confirm the map pin sits on the correct building.
- ☐ **Keep regular opening hours and special hours for public holidays up to date.** — Medium
  How: Add holiday dates to your calendar; fill in the special hours field before each one.
- ☐ **Link the website field to the relevant location page and add UTM parameters.** — Medium
  How: Add parameters such as utm_source=google&utm_medium=organic&utm_campaign=gbp; confirm the traffic in GA4.

02 Google Business Profile: content

- [ ] **Upload real, current photos showing your exterior, interior, team and products/services.** Medium
  How: Review profile photos category by category; replace stock images and outdated photos.
- [ ] **Fill in the Services or Products section with price ranges and short descriptions.** Medium
  How: Compare the service list on your website with the one in the profile; add what is missing.
- [ ] **Publish posts regularly for events, offers and updates.** Low
  How: Create a monthly post calendar; add a button with a UTM-tagged link to the relevant page on each post.
- [ ] **Select the attributes that apply to your business (accessibility, payment options, service options).** Low
  How: Review the attribute list in the profile editor; correct wrong or missing selections.
- [ ] **Since the Q&A feature has been removed, answer frequently asked questions on your website and in the profile description.** Medium
  How: Collect the 10 most common questions from customer-facing staff; add an FAQ section to your location page.
- [ ] **Regularly check for user-suggested edits on the profile and correct inaccurate ones.** Medium
  How: Check notifications in the profile panel and how the listing looks in Google Maps every week.

03 NAP consistency

- [ ] **Define a single standard format for business name, address and phone (NAP).** High
  How: Write the standard in a document, including abbreviations, postcode and phone format (with country code).
- [ ] **Show NAP in the website footer and contact page exactly as it appears in Google Business Profile.** High
  How: Compare the NAP text on the site character by character with the profile.
- [ ] **Correct outdated or wrong NAP records on directory, map and social media profiles.** Medium
  How: Search Google for your old phone number and address in quotes; list every result and request corrections.
- [ ] **Find duplicate Google Business Profile listings for the same location and request their removal.** High
  How: Search Google Maps separately for your name, phone and address; report duplicate listings to Google.

04 Review management

- [ ] **Send every customer a review request containing your short review link after the service.** High
  How: Copy the ask-for-reviews link from the profile panel; add it to your SMS, email or invoice template.
- [ ] **Do not ask only satisfied customers for reviews or discourage negative ones; Google prohibits this.** High
  How: Check that your review request flow has no satisfaction survey filter that sorts customers.
- [ ] **Do not offer discounts, gifts or payment for reviews; do not set review quotas for staff.** High
  How: Review campaign copy and staff bonus guidelines for any review incentives.

- [ ] **Do not allow employees, agencies or acquaintances to post fake or conflict-of-interest reviews.** High
  How: Compare reviewer names with your staff list; policy violations can lead to profile restrictions and a warning banner.
- [ ] **Reply to all positive and negative reviews within a few business days in a personal, calm tone.** Medium
  How: Filter unanswered reviews in the profile panel; personalise reply templates before using them.
- [ ] **Report reviews that violate Google policy and track the status of each report.** Medium
  How: Flag the review as a policy violation; track the outcome in Google's review management tool.
- [ ] **If you work in a regulated field such as health or law, check that your review request and reply process complies with regulations and professional body rules.** Low
  How: Compare your reply templates and review request copy with your legal adviser or your professional body's guidance.

05 Local landing pages and LocalBusiness schema

- [ ] **Create a separate page for each physical location with its address, hours, map, directions and branch-specific content.** High
  How: Open location pages side by side; if only the city name changes in templated text, add unique content to each.
- [ ] **Do not create doorway pages that only swap the place name for cities where you have no real presence.** High
  How: List your service area pages; merge near-duplicates or enrich them with real service information.
- [ ] **Use service and location naturally in the title and H1 of location pages.** Medium
  How: Export and review the titles and H1s of location pages with a crawler.
- [ ] **Make location pages reachable via internal links from the main menu or a "Locations" page.** Low
  How: Check inbound internal link count and click depth of location pages in your crawler.
- [ ] **Add JSON-LD markup to each location page using the most specific LocalBusiness subtype (e.g. Dentist, Restaurant).** Medium
  How: name and address are required; add telephone (with country code), url, geo and openingHoursSpecification and check in the Rich Results Test.
- [ ] **Confirm the NAP and hours in the schema match the visible page and Google Business Profile.** Medium
  How: Compare the JSON-LD values with the page text and profile details.
- [ ] **Do not expect search result stars from marking up reviews of your own business with aggregateRating.** Low
  How: Google does not show LocalBusiness stars for reviews the business controls; review existing markup with this in mind.

06 Local links and directories

- [ ] **Claim and verify your business on other map platforms such as Apple Business Connect, Bing Places and Yandex Business.** Medium
  How: Search for your business on each platform; claim it if a listing exists or create one using your standard NAP.

- [ ] **Get listed in reputable industry directories and professional chamber listings.** Medium
  How: Find directories your competitors appear in with a backlink tool; choose only those with real user traffic.
- [ ] **Earn links to your site from local sponsorships, association memberships and events.** Low
  How: List the organisations and events you support; check whether their sites link to your business.
- [ ] **Pitch stories to local news sites and regional blogs that will get your business mentioned.** Low
  How: Build a list of reporters at local news sites; send a pitch offering data, an event or expert comment.

07 Measurement

- [ ] **Record views, searches and interactions (calls, directions, website clicks) monthly from the Google Business Profile Performance section.** High
  How: Open Performance from the profile panel, select the monthly range and copy the figures into your reporting sheet.
- [ ] **Track UTM-tagged profile traffic separately in GA4 and tie it to conversions.** Medium
  How: Apply a session campaign = gbp filter in GA4 acquisition reports; compare key events.
- [ ] **Track local rankings from different neighbourhoods and points using a location-based rank tracker.** Medium
  How: Measure target keywords around your business in a local rank tracker that offers a map grid.
- [ ] **Monitor how location pages perform for queries containing city and district names in Search Console.** Medium
  How: In the Performance report, filter by the location page and then filter queries by city name.

Detailed guides

Local SEO guide
Google Business Profile
Replying to Google reviews
Schema generator
UTM builder
Local SEO for dental clinics

Need a second pair of eyes on your site? Book a free intro call:
fatihemincakiroglu.com/en/book-a-call

This checklist reflects publicly documented Google guidance as of November 2026. Search features change; check the official documentation before major decisions.